The Redmond Tech Orchestra presents

TCHAIK NIGHT

Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky	Serenade for Strings in C major, Op. 48 Movement IV: Finale - *Tema Russo*	8′
John Mackey	Redline Tango	10′
Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky	1812 Overture, Op. 49	17′
	— Intermission —	
Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky	Symphony No. 5 in E minor, Op. 64	45′

Serenade for Strings in C Major, Op. 48 (Movement IV)

Written in 1880, the same year as the *1812 Overture*, Tchaikovsky's *Serenade for Strings* reveals his admiration for Mozart and strong ties to Russian musical traditions. The fourth movement, dubbed "Tema Russo," serves as a lively and joyful finale. Based on the Russian folk theme *Under the Green Apple Tree*, this movement features energetic rhythms, playful exchanges among the string sections, and a celebratory mood that brings the piece to a satisfying conclusion. It highlights the string ensemble's warmth and unity, showcasing Tchaikovsky's lyrical talent and his ability to transform simple melodies into rich, expressive compositions. This delightful movement offers a pleasing contrast to the program's more dramatic selections.

Redline Tango

Composed in 2004 by John Mackey, "Redline Tango" was inspired by the frenetic pace of urban life and the aggressive energy of an engine. The title is derived from two sources: the first referencing "redlining an engine" (pushing an engine to its max rotational speed) and the second, a nod to the "red line" (2 and 3 trains) of the New York subway system, the train that speeds past the venue where this work was premiered.

A high-energy, rhythmically intense piece that blends tango elements with modern orchestral textures—Mackey's use of syncopation, driving percussion, and sudden dynamic shifts creates a vivid musical landscape that is both exhilarating and unpredictable.

The work unfolds in three distinct sections. The initial section is a virtuosic "redlining" experience, characterized by continuous sixteenth notes that steadily build in intensity. Following this climax, the second section introduces a "tango"—a movement that is light, yet unsettling and can be construed as sleazy. The thematic material for this tango can be heard from the work's opening section. A transition then propels us into an even more intense, "redder" iteration of the first section, culminating in a final, emphatic pop.

1812 Overture

Composed in 1880 by Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky, the *1812 Overture* stands as one of classical music's most iconic pieces, commemorating Russia's victory over Napoleon in 1812. Tchaikovsky masterfully intertwines Russian folk melodies with the French national anthem to vividly depict the conflict between the two nations.

The overture opens with a serene peasant tune, introduced by the strings and then developed by the woodwinds, metaphorizing the purity and strength of Russia. This peaceful atmosphere is abruptly disrupted by a stormy passage, foreshadowing the impending war. The march of Napoleon's army is signaled by a single snare drum, accompanied by strains of *La Marseillaise*, the French national anthem, representing the fierce clash of the armies.

As the forces battle, the piece intensifies, building to a dramatic finale. This climax features cannon fire, church bells, and the Russian national anthem, powerfully symbolizing Russia's triumph and national pride. The musical theme of *God Save the Tsar* can be heard in the finale, which was also referenced in *Slavonic March*, a piece performed earlier this year by the orchestra. The *1812 Overture* remains a testament to Tchaikovsky's ability to blend historical narrative with musical grandeur, its dramatic contrasts and rich orchestration making it a beloved choice for both outdoor and celebratory performances alike.

Symphony No. 5 in E Minor, Op. 64

Composed in 1888, Tchaikovsky's Fifth Symphony is a profound exploration of providence, struggle, and ultimate redemption. Though this piece doesn't have a story in the traditional sense, the recurring "fate" motif serves as a unifying thread throughout the symphony. Each movement presents a different emotional landscape—from melancholy and introspection to passionate intensity and triumphant resolution.

The first movement opens with a somber introduction, embodying Tchaikovsky's description of "complete resignation." This tone is set by the "fate" theme, announced by clarinets in their low register. The main body transitions to a sturdy march subject, also introduced by clarinets and then picked up by other instruments. The interplay between this martial theme and several more genial ideas creates much of the movement's excitement.

The ensuing second movement, *Andante cantabile, con alcuna licenza* (at a lyrical, walking pace with some freedom), features a beautiful horn solo. This captivating atmosphere is twice disrupted by fierce eruptions of the main leitmotif.

The third movement features waltz melodies reminiscent of Tchaikovsky's fairytale ballets. Near its close, the "fate" theme from the first movement reappears, but it seems tame and powerless in the ideally elegant world constructed by the prior movement. This movement is the most distinctive, a graceful dance in which Tchaikovsky again exploits a wide range of instrumental color.

The final movement transforms the fate theme into a victorious march, symbolizing the triumph of the human spirit. Tchaikovsky's reliance on dance rhythms, particularly waltzes and marches, contributes to the symphony's cyclic unity and highlights his innate gift as a composer for the ballet stage. This symphony, with its emotional depth and orchestral brilliance, provides a powerful conclusion to the evening's program.

Violin I
Isabel Milewski
Mirabai Smoot
Audra Stump
Bonnie You
Bryan Reich
Emily Jin
Ian Fernandes
Isabella de Leon
Jerry He
Madeleine Jacobitz
Patrick Creighton
Ruying Sun
William Sun

Violin II
Brandon Chen
Erica Choi
Aditya Ramanathan
Alan Zhu
Amy Ouyang
Farrah Hasen
Frederick Huyan
Gabriel Mallari
Michael Manansala
Rachael Tang
Rodrigo Castaño
Sophie Zhao
Trevor Jones

Viola
Jacob Park
Eleanor Mengel
Anita Ambalavanan
Henry Wang
Lauren Kam
Sumit Choudhury
Xun Yu

Cello
Dorian Latchague
Rodrigo Ramirez
Alaina Bossert
Aleksandar Boljanac
Jason Dickens
Lotus Kam Chow
Taylor Thackaberry

Double Bass
Alex Hansen
Adrian Pang
Supriya Dixit
Tanya Lai

Flute
Jennifer Lee
Alejandro Rios
Alex Ayala*
Erica Li
Martha Tran
Nandhini Lakuduva*
Robin Goldstein
Yoona Oh

Piccolo
Alex Ayala*
Nandhini Lakuduva*

Oboe
Jennifer Williams
Bora McAteer

E♭ Clarinet
Vicky Harp

Clarinet
Emily You
Helen Xiong
Michael Taylor
Moe Tsuboike
Renee Hsu
Tom Glanz
Vicky Harp*
Joanna Chu*

Bass Clarinet
*Joanna Chu**

Bassoon
Joshua Schnipke
Seger Smith

Contrabassoon
Eric Shankland

Horn
Caeli MacLennan
Andrew Schuck
Jon Dyer
Linda Brooking

Trumpet
Sven Boemer
Brooke Shendok
Ethan Wong
Tony Gepner

Trombone
Cole Brooking
Conall Anderson
Johnny Leek
Zach Neely

Tuba
Adithya Subbiah

Timpani
Thomas Tavarez
Matthew Kangas*

Percussion
*Matthew Kangas**
Aaryaa Tiwari
Chase Lee
Enrique Saurez
Nicholas Vadasz
Soo Stahl
Spencer Nisonoff

Keys
Jada Campbell

Harp
Tamara Dobranic

Add'l String Players
Amanda Pang
Peter Chow

Conductor
Peter Yang

Italics denotes principal
*Denotes doubling

Tchaik a break!

Symphonic (Word) Search

L	C	S	U	C	Y	L	P	I	A	R	T	S	E	H	C	R	O	S	N
T	C	P	S	U	G	A	R	P	L	U	M	O	N	A	I	P	V	R	P
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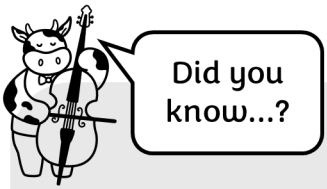
BALLET	CANNON	CELESTA	COMPOSER
CONCERT	HARMONY	MELODY	NUTCRACKER
OPERA	ORCHESTRA	OVERTURE	PIANO
RUSSIA	SUGAR PLUM	SWAN LAKE	SYMPHONY



Tchaikovsky began playing piano when he was just **four years old** and composed songs with his little sister **Alexandra**!

Tchaikovsky was the special guest conductor at the very **first** concert in New York's famous **Carnegie Hall.**

Over his lifetime, Tchaikovsky wrote **11 operas, 3 ballets**, and over **100 songs!**

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Our Mascot

Moomie's musical journey began on the farms of Carnation, WA, when she started learning cowbell at just three months old. Her musical talents brought her to the Redmond Tech Orchestra where she happily spends her days enjoying soft classical music, munching on organic grass and grains, and being loved by the members of the orchestra.

In her spare time, Moomie loves to explore the Puget Sound and to find new friends to share her love of music. Her all-time favorite composers are Brahms and Ravel, and she loves Saint-Saëns' *Carnival of the Animals*, which has so many references to her animal friends! Moomie's excited to meet you all and see you at our future concerts.

Fun fact: Moomie weighs 10.2 pounds!

Upcoming Concerts

April 4, 2026 @ Meydenbauer Convention Center (Bellevue)
July 18, 2026 @ The Pursuit (Kirkland)

Support the Orchestra

As a nonprofit organization, the Redmond Tech Orchestra relies on your generous donations to continue bringing music to the community. Your support helps us organize events and foster a love for music in the greater Redmond area. Please consider donating to help us keep the music alive. Every contribution, no matter the size, makes a significant impact.

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